

Quantum Computing

Part 8 - Industry, Academia & Claims: SPAC Mergers & Public Listings

Compiled by the Spaced Research Ledger

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Between February and August 2026, six quantum computing companies became publicly traded. Five did it by merging with a special purpose acquisition company, usually shortened to SPAC. A SPAC is a listed shell company holding cash and looking for a business to combine with. The sixth ran a conventional initial public offering.

That distinction matters more than it sounds. A SPAC merger lets a company publish its own revenue projections to investors, which a conventional offering does not permit in the same way. The first wave of quantum SPACs, covered in Section 1, published projections that its companies then missed by a wide margin. Reading the 2026 wave without that history gives the wrong impression of what these valuations mean.

Two terms recur below. A PIPE is a private investment placed at the same time as the merger, and it usually provides more of the cash than the shell company does. Redemptions are shareholders in the shell taking their money back instead of staying invested, and a low redemption rate signals confidence in the deal.

Sections 2 through 6 cover the five completed SPAC mergers in order of closing. Section 7 covers the one conventional offering. Section 8 covers deals announced but not yet closed, and Section 9 covers what the resulting companies have reported since.

1. The 2021 Cohort and Its Record

Five quantum companies went public between 2021 and 2024, and their delivery against their own published projections is the single most useful piece of context for everything that follows.

Current State

IonQ merged with dMY Technology Group III at roughly a \$2 billion valuation and listed in October 2021 [1]. Arqit merged with Centricus Acquisition Corp. at roughly \$1 billion and listed in September 2021. Rigetti merged with Supernova Partners II at \$1.15 billion and listed in March 2022.

D-Wave and Zapata followed. D-Wave merged with DPCM Capital at up to \$1.6 billion and listed in August 2022. Zapata merged with Andretti Acquisition Corp. and listed in April 2024 [1].

Zapata then ceased operations that October and restructured as an over-the-counter company [1].

The delivery record against projections is stark. Against combined promised 2025 revenue of roughly \$1.185 billion, the group reported roughly \$138 million, which the source describes as twelve cents on the projected dollar [1].

The individual figures vary widely. IonQ delivered about 55% of its projection, \$130 million against \$237 million, and missed its profitability promise by approximately \$248 million [1]. Rigetti delivered about 2.5%, \$7.1 million against \$288 million [1]. Arqit delivered under 0.1%, roughly \$0.5 million against \$660 million, and settled shareholder litigation for \$7 million [1]. D-Wave missed the profitability milestone it had promised for the second quarter of 2025 and remained loss-making at year end on \$24.6 million of revenue [1].

Share prices followed. Arqit lost more than 90% from its peak. Rigetti declined 84% within six months of listing and received a delisting warning. IonQ fell roughly 70% from its highs before a later rally [1].

2. Inflection

Inflection listed first in the 2026 wave and had the lowest redemption rate of any deal in this part. Almost all the shell company's cash came through to the business.

Recent Developments

Inflection updated its reported second-quarter 2026 revenue from \$12.63 million to \$13.5 million, and raised full-year guidance from approximately \$43 million to approximately \$45.1 million [35]. The change came from an accounting adjustment shifting revenue recognition timing on two government contracts, with no effect on cash or the underlying business.

Current State

The company, legally ColdQuanta, entered a definitive merger agreement with Churchill Capital Corp X in September 2025, and the joint registration statement was declared effective in January 2026 [2]. It began trading on the New York Stock Exchange under the ticker INFQ on 17 February 2026, at a \$1.8 billion valuation [3]. It was the first neutral-atom hardware and sensing company to reach public markets. Reported second-quarter revenue was up 116% year over year [5].

The deal delivered approximately \$550 million in gross proceeds, including a \$125 million PIPE [4]. Redemptions were under 0.10%, which is close to nobody taking their money back.

Trading has been weaker than the fundamentals. The stock debuted at \$14.25 and traded at \$12.36 at the most recent quote available, down 27.9% year to date despite the raised guidance [6]. It remains above the \$10.00 nominal price at which SPAC shares are usually issued.

3. Xanadu

Xanadu is the photonic company from Part 4. Its merger drew almost all its cash from private investors rather than the shell company, and its share price has given back an extraordinary run.

Current State

Xanadu entered a merger agreement with Crane Harbor Acquisition Corp. in November 2025, valuing the company at \$3.6 billion [7]. The merger closed on 26 March 2026, and the company began trading on both Nasdaq and the Toronto Stock Exchange under the ticker XNDU the following day [8]. It became the first publicly listed pure-play photonic quantum technology company.

The funding structure is the notable part. Gross proceeds were \$301.6 million, made up of \$275.0 million in PIPE financing and \$26.6 million from the shell company's trust account [8]. The trust provided under 9% of the total, meaning private investors, not the SPAC mechanism, funded this listing.

Quarterly results have been uneven. First-quarter 2026 revenue was \$2.83 million, roughly four times the prior-year quarter, with a net loss of \$20.6 million and \$272.5 million of cash [9]. Second-quarter revenue was \$1.51 million, up 42.5% year over year but down sequentially from the first quarter [10]. Cash rose to \$312.8 million after \$67.2 million was raised through an at-the-market equity facility.

Revenue falling by nearly half between quarters while cash rises is a picture of a company funded by investors rather than customers.

The share price reflects a full round trip. XNDU traded at \$10.41 in late August 2026 with a market capitalization of \$3.17 billion, against a 52-week range of \$6.97 to \$42.44 [11]. That is within about 4% of the \$10.00 nominal SPAC price. Canaccord lowered its price target to \$34 from \$45 in August 2026 [11].

4. Horizon Quantum

Horizon Quantum is the only software company among the 2026 listings, and it raised the least money of the five.

Current State

The company completed a merger with dMY Squared Technology Group and began trading on Nasdaq on 20 March 2026, under the tickers HQ for shares and HQWWW for warrants [12]. Gross proceeds were approximately \$120 million, directed toward research and development, a hardware testbed, and the company's integrated development environment.

The deal valuation is reported inconsistently. A sector survey gives \$503 million [1], while the company's own annual report filing summary gives \$508 million for the same transaction [13].

5. IQM

IQM is the superconducting company from Part 1. It became the first publicly traded European quantum company, and is the only one in this part with a dual listing on two continents.

Current State

IQM entered a definitive agreement with Real Asset Acquisition Corp. in February 2026 at a pre-money equity valuation of approximately \$1.8 billion [14]. Existing shareholders rolled all their equity and accepted lock-ups rather than cashing out, which is a stronger signal than any projection.

The announced structure anticipated up to roughly \$175 million from the shell company's trust, \$134 million from a PIPE, and \$24 million from warrant exercises [15]. The combined cash position was projected above \$450 million. The PIPE was later upsized to more than \$146 million through an additional commitment from the Finnish pension insurer Ilmarinen [16].

Shareholders approved in June 2026 and the merger became effective on 1 July [17]. American depositary shares began trading on the Nasdaq Global Select Market on 2 July under the ticker IQMX [18]. A parallel listing on Nasdaq Helsinki commenced the next day, with 262,462,360 shares admitted to trading [19].

At listing the merger valued IQM at roughly \$1.9 billion and generated about €198 million in net proceeds after costs, leaving a pro forma cash position of €337 million [18]. The shares fell about 7.5% early on the first trading day before recovering to close up about 2% [18].

The operating figures are the strongest in this part. Second-quarter 2026 revenue was €6.7 million, with first-half revenue of €8.9 million, up 47% year over year [20]. The second-quarter operating loss was €30.9 million, and the first-half loss €60.5 million, reflecting research spending and listing costs.

Order backlog rose from €67.3 million entering 2026 to more than €102 million after the second quarter, and the company signed a further €33.0 million contract in July [21]. IQM held €309.4 million in cash after listing, which management said funds the company through the second quarter of 2028 [20]. It reaffirmed full-year targets of €42 million to €47 million in revenue and €65 million to €75 million in order intake [20].

6. Pasqal

Pasqal is the neutral-atom company from Part 3, and the most recent listing in this part. It closed two days before this report and is the only one whose shares rose sharply on debut.

Recent Developments

Pasqal shares nearly doubled during the company's first day of trading on Nasdaq after the merger closed [36]. Set against the flat and negative debuts elsewhere in this part, that is a marked difference in reception.

Current State

Pasqal announced a definitive agreement with Bleichroeder Acquisition Corp. II in March 2026, at a \$2 billion pre-money valuation including \$200 million of committed capital through convertible financing [22]. The registration statement was declared effective in August 2026 [23], and shareholders approved the combination on 25 August [24].

The combination completed and shares and warrants began trading on Nasdaq on 28 August 2026, under the tickers PSQL and PSQLW [24]. Approximately \$360 million of cash was available at closing.

The company named four uses for the proceeds: expanding processor manufacturing and deployment, advancing toward fault-tolerant computing, broadening cloud and software access, and deepening integration with conventional high-performance computing [24]. No financial projections accompanied the closing, which distinguishes it from the 2021 cohort in Section 1.

7. Quantinuum

Quantinuum is the trapped-ion company from Part 2 and the only company in this part to use a conventional initial public offering. It is also by far the largest listing, at roughly ten times the valuation of any SPAC deal here.

Current State

Quantinuum, majority owned by Honeywell, submitted a confidential registration statement in February 2026 [25]. It filed publicly in May, when pre-pricing expectations put the opening range at \$45 to \$50 per share [26].

It priced above that range. The company sold 28 million Class A shares at \$60 each, raising \$1.68 billion in gross proceeds [27]. It listed on the Nasdaq Global Market under the ticker QNT on 4 June 2026. The pricing implied an initial equity valuation of \$17.63 billion, the largest pure-play quantum listing to date, with the order book reported as 20 times oversubscribed [28]. The stock closed flat on its first day despite the upsized offering [29].

The first quarterly report as a public company came in August 2026. Revenue was \$8.00 million, up 279.4% year over year, against a total net loss of \$597 million that included large one-time stock-based compensation related to the listing [30]. The company reported over \$2 billion in cash [30]. Second-quarter bookings were \$4.3 million against year-to-date bookings of \$81 million, with a full-year bookings target of at least \$120 million. Full-year revenue guidance is \$28 million to \$32 million.

A \$17.63 billion valuation against \$28 million to \$32 million of expected annual revenue is the widest such gap in this part.

8. Announced Deals Not Yet Closed

Two further transactions are signed and pending, both at valuations above \$3 billion.

Current State

EigenQ and Silicon Valley Acquisition Corp. have submitted a draft registration statement advancing their announced combination [31]. It values EigenQ at a pro forma enterprise value of approximately \$3.0 billion, with an anticipated close in the fourth quarter of 2026 and an expected ticker of EIGQ.

Terra Quantum signed a definitive agreement with Axiom Intelligence Acquisition Corp 1 in May 2026 [32]. The deal values it at approximately \$3.5 billion in equity, with up to \$190 million in gross proceeds. The combined company is expected to trade on Nasdaq under the ticker TQ, remain headquartered in St. Gallen, Switzerland, and close in the second half of 2026.

9. Post-Listing Reporting and Share Prices

This section covers what the companies from the earlier wave are reporting now, and how the whole group has traded. The revenue figures are growing quickly from small bases, and the share prices have fallen together.

Current State

IonQ reported second-quarter 2026 revenue of \$80.1 million, up 287% year over year [33]. Remaining performance obligations were \$485 million, against an adjusted loss of \$120.3 million on that measure. It raised full-year guidance to between \$280 million and \$290 million.

D-Wave reported second-quarter revenue of \$3.1 million, with 62% from commercial customers, up from 45% a year earlier [33]. Rigetti reported \$5.1 million in revenue against an operating loss of \$28.1 million [33]. Quantum Computing Inc. posted first-quarter revenue of \$3.69 million against roughly \$1.4 billion in total cash and investments [33]. All three of IonQ, D-Wave and Rigetti remained unprofitable [33].

Share prices moved together rather than on company news. Over a single trailing month in 2026, IonQ fell 39% while Rigetti and D-Wave each fell about 30% [34]. The source attributes the move to investor concern about valuations relative to profitability rather than to any company-specific event.

About This Report

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